



## MONEY

Money can't buy happiness, but it can buy a good diet, access to gyms, spas and health-care. And they all help you live longer. A survey published in the *New England Journal of Medicine* reports that the rich are healthier.

## NUTS

Fatty nuts are back on the menu, to prevent heart disease or lose weight. Nuts pack unsaturated fats and are potent sources of antioxidants, proteins and vitamins. If you don't overdose, they can fight cholesterol and cancer.



## OLIVE OIL

A big part of the hugely healthy 'Mediterranean Diet'. If you can afford it, go for the extra virgin variety for maximum benefits. The *Annals of Internal Medicine* reports extra-virgin olive oil is the best for increasing good HDL cholesterol. But don't go overboard, olive oil is caloric.

## POMEGRANATE

It has got a lot of good press lately as a cancer-fighting fruit. Research indicates that the fruit, rich in antioxidants, has healing and health-boosting properties. It is particularly appealing to nutritionists: it becomes more potent when squeezed into a liquid.



## QUIET TIME

Living in the fast lane might be cool, but it also gives you health risks. S-l-o-w d-o-w-n. Sleep, look through old photographs, listen to music. The de-stressing aspects of "quiet time" are hugely underestimated.

## RED WINE

More good news for tipplers. The grape not only helps stave off heart disease and cancer, it may play a role in longevity. Men shouldn't drink more than three to four small glasses a day, though, and women no more than two to three. What better excuse to raise a glass of Bordeaux every day?



## SEX

It's official! Sex is good for you. It helps you live longer by slowing down the ageing process, reduces flab by burning up loads of calories, boosts the immune system, strengthens the heart, bones and increases circulation. Is there anything it can't do?



We all know smoking is bad. But now doctors say it's especially bad for men. A new study reports, the sperm of chronic smokers (four or more cigarettes a day for at least two years) are 75 per cent less fertile. Can they bounce back to normal? The medics don't have the answer yet.

## UNSATURATED FAT

This is better than the saturated variety and is found plenty in vegetable oils and oil-rich fish. Oily fish also contains omega-3 polyunsaturated fatty acids, which maintain supple joints, healthy skin, hair, teeth and bones.



## VITAMINS

The row continues: do vitamins in tablet form do the trick or a balanced diet gives the daily quota? Some doubt the body's capacity to absorb them. Others think it is possible to overdose on some in tablet form. Vegetarians should be able to source all vitamins naturally in a balanced diet.



## WORK OUT

Bad news for couch potatoes: Sedentary lifestyle is most devastating to health and people who exercise live longer. Moderate activity or walking 30 minutes a day can add up to four years to your lifespan.



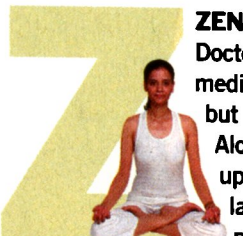
## X SYNDROME

You gain a kg and have trouble losing it, feel hungry after a hearty meal and sluggish despite sleep. You have Syndrome X, which leads to diabetes and the works. Way out? Lump the junk and stick to a balanced diet.



## YO-YO DIETING

People who lose weight through dieting often regain and add more weight than what they lost. They may develop heart disease, hypertension, diabetes and stress. Yo-Yo is most dangerous to those battling the last few excess kgs. Beware!



## ZEN

Doctors are spreading the good word about meditation, not because they think it's cool but because studies show that it works. Along with yoga, it can reverse the build-up of plaque in coronary arteries, lower lactic acid levels and restore balance in psychiatric disturbances. Just say 'Om'.